2026 SIMSON DEBATE TOURNAMENT

Readings & Clash Points

Day 1 Background and Perspectives, and Day 2 Clash Points and Rebuttals, collected from the 2026 Simson Debate books.

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Motion **THBT rent freezes are a form of harmful populism.**

Purpose To discuss how rent freezes affect the economy and society and what problems they may cause.

Background

Is a rent freeze populism or a helpful policy?

People can live in a house they buy or in a house they rent. When people rent a house, they pay money every month. This money is called rent. A rent freeze stops rent from going up for a certain time. Many people say rent freezes help renters. They say it is a quick way to stop rent from rising too fast.

But people do not all agree. Some people think rent freezes are harmful populism. Others think they are very important for housing **stability**.

Because of this, rent freezes are debated from many sides. People talk about them in economic ways and social ways.

Perspective 1 : Economic

Pro (Populism that distorts the market)

Some people think rent freezes are a form of populism because they **distort** how the market works. While rent freezes may become popular in the short term, they argue that in the long run they cause economic problems and market **imbalance**. For example, in 2019, Berlin in Germany introduced a rent freeze policy. This policy helped some renters for a short time, but over time it caused housing shortages and made rents rise very quickly.

When rent cannot move freely, **landlords** earn less money, so some stop renting out their homes while others stop repairing and managing them properly. As a result, the supply of rental housing **decreases**, and rent may increase sharply in the long run.

In addition, governments often try to support the rental market by building public housing or giving subsidies, but this can lead to higher taxes and **financial** problems. For these reasons, rent freezes are often criticized as a populist policy.

Con (Economic Stability Measure)

On the other hand, some people see rent freezes as a way to keep the economy stable. They argue that rent freezes can reduce the harm caused by fast-rising rents to people and to the economy. When rent is frozen, people have more money left to spend on other things, which can help the local economy. For example, in Barcelona, Spain, rent freezes helped stop housing costs from rising too fast and made life easier for people. This helped the local economy.

When housing costs stay stable, people can spend more money on other things. This helps shops and businesses. In this way, rent freezes stop rent from rising suddenly and help keep the market stable for a short time.

Perspective 2 : Social

Pro (Causing Social Inequality)

From a social view, some people say rent freezes are not fair. They say rent freezes help people who already live in rented homes, but people who want to move to a new home face higher rent and fewer choices. This can make life unfair for some people. For example, in Barcelona, Spain, rent freezes helped current renters for a short time, but new renters later had fewer homes to choose from and had to pay more rent.

Because of this, young people and newly married couples can have a harder time finding a home. Over time, this can make social **inequality** worse. For these reasons, some people say rent freezes are a populist and unfair policy.

Con (Protecting the Vulnerable)

On the other hand, some people say rent freezes help protect **vulnerable** people in society. They say that without government rules, rent can rise faster than people's income, which makes life harder for poor people and young people. For example, in Vienna, Austria, strong rent rules and many public houses have helped people find homes at lower prices. This has helped reduce **unfairness** in society.

In this way, rent freezes can give short-term safety and help vulnerable people live more securely. They also help people with different incomes live together, which can make society more united.

Conclusion

Is it populism or a practical solution? The debate over rent freezes remains a hot social issue, with criticism that it is populism and arguments that it is an essential solution from both economic and social perspectives. Some worry that it distorts market functions and increases social inequality, seeing it as short-term populism, while others argue that rent freezes are a **necessary** measure to protect the public and ensure economic stability.

In the end, for this policy to be an effective solution, the design and implementation of the policy are crucial, and an approach that balances short-term stability with long-term sustainability is needed.

Figure out the Clash Points VS ↔

In terms of Economy

1 Proposition argues that:

Populism that Distorts the Market

Rent freezes may be popular for a short time, but they can hurt how the market works in the long run and cause economic problems.

When rent is controlled, landlords earn less money, so some stop renting their homes or stop fixing and taking care of them.

Because of this, there are fewer rental homes, and rent may go up a lot later. (Example: Berlin, Germany, 2019)

Rebuttals Economic Stability Measure

Rent freezes can help people when rent rises too fast and can also help the economy.

When rent stays stable, people have more money to spend on other things, which helps local shops and creates a good cycle in the economy.

In terms of Economy

1 Opposition argues that:

Economic Stability Measure

Rent freezes are seen as a way to keep the economy stable and help people when housing costs rise too fast.

When rent is frozen, people feel less money pressure even if their income does not rise as fast as housing costs.

Rent freezes stop rent from rising suddenly and help keep the market stable for a short time. (Example: Barcelona, Spain)

Rebuttals Populism that Distorts the Market

When rent cannot move freely, landlords earn less money, so some stop renting their homes or stop fixing them.

Because of this, there are fewer homes to rent, and rent may go up a lot in the future.

Also, when the government builds public housing or gives money to help, taxes may go up and government money problems can happen.

Figure out the Clash Points VS ↔

In terms of society

2 Proposition argues that:

Causing Social Inequality

This policy mainly helps people who already rent homes, but new renters may face higher rent and fewer choices.

While existing tenants get short-term help, young people and newlyweds who are looking for a new home may have to pay more and have fewer places to choose from.

Because this situation can increase inequality between generations, the policy is criticized as unfair since it protects existing tenants more than other vulnerable groups, such as new renters.

Rebuttals Protecting the Vulnerable

Without government rules, rent can rise faster than people's income and make society more unfair.

Rent freezes give short-term safety to young people and low-income groups who struggle to find stable housing because rent is too high.

In terms of society

2 Opposition argues that:

Protecting the Vulnerable

Rent freezes are an important policy to help vulnerable people afford housing.

They give short-term stability, so vulnerable people can live more safely.

By keeping housing affordable, rent freezes help people with different incomes live together in society.

(Example: Vienna, Austria, with public housing and strong rent rules)

Rebuttals Causing Social Inequality

The policy helps only people who already rent homes, while new renters like young people and newlyweds have fewer housing choices.

This makes it harder for new renters to improve their lives and can increase unfairness between current renters and new renters.

Motion **THBT humanoid robots like Atlas must be restricted from fully replacing humans in automobile factories.**

Purpose To see if full robot automation makes society and the economy better, or if limits are needed to keep things stable for the future.

Background

Humanoid robots like Atlas can now do complex work in car factories. They promise faster production and lower costs. But the real question is simple.

Should governments allow robots to replace workers completely? Or should they put limits on it? This debate looks at social **stability**, job change, and economic stability.

Perspective 1 : Social

Pro (Social Stability and Worker Protection)

From a social perspective, **unlimited automation** can cause serious problems.

First, many people can lose their jobs at once. Factory workers cannot quickly move to high-skill jobs. For example, after automation expanded in Amazon warehouses, many low-skill workers lost jobs, and only a few moved into technical roles.

Second, inequality can grow. Skilled technicians **benefit**, but replaced workers struggle.

Third, fast change can damage communities. When factories suddenly cut workers, local businesses **decline** and people become unhappy. So limits act as protection and give society time to adjust.

Con (Worker Safety and Social Progress)

Opponents say automation helps society.

First, robots take dangerous and **repetitive** tasks. In Tesla factories, workers moved

away from risky assembly work to checking and managing roles.

Second, technology usually changes jobs instead of removing them. After computers and the internet spread, companies like Microsoft created new jobs in IT, cybersecurity, and data science.

So blocking automation may slow long-term progress.

Perspective 2 : Economic

Pro (Consumer Collapse and Market Concentration)

Economically, unlimited automation also has risks.

First, production has little value without buyers. After automation increased in Foxconn factories, large layoffs happened and local business activity fell.

Second, **unemployment** increases government spending over time.

Third, automation helps large companies more than small ones. General Motors increased **productivity**, but mass **layoffs weakened** local middle-class communities.

So short-term efficiency does not always mean long-term growth.

Con (Productivity, Competitiveness, and Economic Transformation)

Opponents say automation strengthens the economy.

First, higher productivity lowers costs and increases demand.

Second, companies need automation to compete globally. Without it, they fall behind in price and quality.

Third, automation creates new industries. BMW increased productivity and used tax money for worker training. Also, flexible rules helped companies like Toss grow quickly and create new markets.

So controlled innovation can support long-term economic growth.

Conclusion

This debate is not about rejecting technology. It is about controlling its effects.

Supporters of limits worry about social instability, lower spending, and big-company dominance. Opponents focus on safety, productivity, and economic change.

In the end, the question is:

Should society choose maximum efficiency, or balanced progress with safety rules?

Figure out the Clash Points VS ↔

In terms of Society

1 Proposition argues that:

Social Stability and Worker Protection

Unlimited automation causes mass job loss.

Most factory workers cannot quickly move to high-skill jobs.

This increases inequality and weakens local communities.

So limits are needed to allow gradual adjustment and protect social stability.

Rebuttals Technological Transformation and Social Progress

Technology has always changed jobs.

Automation changes work instead of simply removing it.

Robots take dangerous tasks and workers move to better roles.

Unemployment should be solved with training and policy, not by stopping technology.

In terms of Society

1 Opposition argues that:

Job Transformation and Shared Responsibility

Social responsibility does not mean stopping progress.

Automation is not the only cause of unemployment.

Lack of retraining and policy also causes job loss.

Blaming robots ignores the duty of governments and companies to help workers move to new jobs.

Technology has always changed jobs rather than permanently removing them.

Rebuttals Speed and Structural Shock

Humanoid automation replaces workers quickly and on a large scale.

Factory workers cannot instantly become robotics engineers or AI managers.

Unlike past gradual change, this shift can cause sudden unemployment.

Training takes time, but job loss happens immediately.

So those pushing rapid automation should take primary responsibility.

Figure out the Clash Points VS ↔

In terms of Economy

2 Proposition argues that:

Market Stability and Sustainable Growth

Unlimited automation may weaken the economic system.

Mass unemployment reduces spending and demand.

Productivity has little value if people cannot afford products.

Automation also increases welfare costs and long-term government burden.

It favors large companies with capital and pushes small firms out, reducing competition.

So limits are needed to protect market balance and long-term stability.

Rebuttals Innovation and Market Growth

Unemployment does not always destroy demand.

Lower costs reduce prices and expand access to goods.

Higher productivity increases profits and tax money, which can support training and welfare.

Market concentration is not only caused by automation but also weak competition policy.

Restricting automation may reduce competitiveness and slow growth.

Sustainable growth comes from innovation and adaptation, not limitation.

In terms of Economy

2 Opposition argues that:

Productivity and Competitiveness

Automation increases productivity and lowers costs.

Lower costs reduce prices and increase demand.

Global competition requires advanced automation.

Without it, companies fall behind in quality and efficiency.

Automation also creates new industries such as robotics, AI, and system management.

Economic growth should come from innovation, not restriction.

Rebuttals Consumer Base and Market Stability

Productivity has little meaning without consumers.

Large unemployment reduces spending and demand.

Automation favors large companies and reduces competition.

Short-term efficiency can cause long-term instability.

Sustainable growth requires balancing innovation and stability.

Motion **THBT companies' excess profits should be distributed to workers before shareholders.**

Purpose To examine how companies should balance fairness and economic growth when deciding whether excess profits should go first to workers or shareholders.

Background

In modern **capitalism**, when a company makes more profit than expected, it can use that money in many ways. It can give money to **shareholders**, spend money on research and development, grow its business, or give bonuses and higher wages to workers. Shareholders say they deserve profits because they give money to the company and take financial risks. Workers say they also deserve a fair share because they create value through their work.

This issue became more important in South Korea because of the Samsung Electronics labor **dispute**. In 2026, Samsung Electronics and its labor union reached a temporary wage **agreement** after months of conflict. Under the agreement, Samsung decided to create a special bonus system for its **semiconductor** division. This bonus would come from part of the division's operating profit. In other words, part of the company's success would be shared directly with workers.

This case shows the main question of this debate. If workers help create a company's excess profits, should they receive those profits first as bonuses and higher wages? Or should shareholders receive them first because they invested money and took financial risks?

Perspective 1 : Social

Pro (Fair Reward for Labor)

Companies' excess profits should go to workers before shareholders because this can make society fairer and reduce income inequality.

The reason why this is important is that workers help a company succeed. They make products, provide services, and keep the company running every day. So, if a company makes more profit than expected, some of that excess profit should go back to the workers.

Also, shareholders often invest with money they already have, but many workers

depend on wages to live. If excess profits go only to shareholders, the gap between rich **asset** owners and workers can become bigger. However, if companies share those profits with workers, workers' lives can improve.

For example, the Samsung Electronics labor dispute shows this point. Samsung reached a wage agreement with its labor union, and it included performance bonuses. This shows that workers' contribution was reflected in the agreement.

Con (New Inequality Among Workers)

Companies' excess profits should not go to workers before shareholders because this policy may create new unfairness among workers.

The reason why this can be a problem is that companies with large excess profits are usually big or very successful companies. Their workers often already get higher wages and better benefits than workers in small businesses, subcontractors, or temporary jobs. If these workers get excess profits first, the benefit will stay inside successful companies.

This can make other workers feel left out. Also, it is unclear who should get the benefit. Should only regular workers get it? Should **subcontracted** or temporary workers get it too? This can create another fairness problem.

For example, the Samsung Electronics performance bonus issue in 2026 shows this problem. Reports said that semiconductor workers could get large bonuses, but other workers were excluded. Also, in capitalism, risk and reward are important. Since shareholders take financial risks by investing money, excess profits should mainly return to shareholders.

Perspective 2 : Economic

Pro (More Consumption and Productivity)

Companies' excess profits should go to workers before shareholders because this can increase spending, improve worker **motivation**, and help the economy.

The reason why this is economically helpful is that workers are more likely to spend extra money on daily needs, such as food, housing, education, and services. On the other

hand, wealthy shareholders may save the money or invest it. Therefore, when excess profits go to workers, the money returns to the market faster and increases demand.

Also, sharing profits with workers can increase their motivation and **loyalty** to the company. This can improve productivity and reduce turnover. From a company's point of view, this is not just a cost. It is an investment in workers.

For example, profit-sharing systems and employee stock ownership plans, or ESOPs, can make workers care more about company performance. The efficiency wage theory also says that better rewards can increase worker motivation and productivity. Therefore, sharing excess profits with workers can increase both spending and productivity.

Con (Less Investment and Growth)

Companies' excess profits should not go to workers before shareholders because this can reduce investment and weaken long-term economic growth.

The reason why this is dangerous is that if shareholders receive less money, companies may become less attractive to investors. Investors usually move their money to places where they can earn higher returns. Therefore, if excess profits are given to workers first, companies may have more difficulty raising money for future growth.

Also, sharing excess profits can become a long-term **burden**. Once workers receive large bonuses, it may be hard to reduce them later, even when the economy gets worse. Then, companies may have less money for facilities, research and development, new technology, and future jobs.

For example, the Samsung Electronics performance bonus issue in 2026 shows this concern. The discussion about large bonuses came when the company also needed huge investment in semiconductor facilities, research and development, and AI-based automated factories. If those profits were used for investment or shareholder returns, they could have helped the company prepare for future competition. Therefore, giving excess profits to workers first may use up money needed for long-term growth.

Figure out the Clash Points VS ↔

In terms of Social

1 Proposition argues that:

Fair Reward for Labor

Workers help a company succeed by making products, providing services, and keeping the company running every day. Therefore, when a company makes more profit than expected, it is fair that workers receive some of those excess profits before shareholders. Many workers depend on wages to live, while shareholders often invest with money or assets they already have. If excess profits go only to shareholders, the gap between rich asset owners and workers can become bigger.

Rebuttals Fairness Requires Rewarding Investment Risk

Workers help a company succeed, but they are not the only group that contributes to the company's success. Shareholders also contribute by giving money to the company and taking financial risks. Without shareholders' investment, companies may not have enough money to build facilities, develop products, hire workers, or grow their business. Therefore, fairness should not focus only on workers' labor. It should also recognize investment and financial risk.

In terms of Social

1 Opposition argues that:

New Inequality Among Workers

Companies' excess profits should not go to workers before shareholders because this may create new unfairness among workers. Companies with large excess profits are usually big or very successful companies. Their workers often already receive higher wages and better benefits than workers in small businesses, subcontractors, or temporary jobs. If these workers receive large bonuses first, the benefit may stay only inside successful companies. This can make other workers feel left out.

Rebuttals Broader Fairness Begins with Rewarding Workers

The claim that excess profit sharing creates new unfairness among workers is limited. Even if workers in big companies already receive better wages, this does not mean they should be excluded from the profits they helped create. Fairness should first recognize the direct contribution of workers inside the company. Also, companies can design the policy to include subcontracted workers and temporary workers who helped the company's performance. Therefore, the real problem is not sharing excess profits with workers itself. The real problem is how fairly the system is designed.

Figure out the Clash Points VS ↔

In terms of Economic

2 Proposition argues that:

More Consumption and Productivity

Companies' excess profits should go to workers before shareholders because this can increase spending and productivity. Workers are more likely to spend extra money on daily needs, such as food, housing, education, and services. This means the money can return to the market faster and increase demand. Also, sharing profits with workers can improve their motivation and loyalty to the company. This can improve productivity and reduce turnover. Therefore, excess profit sharing is not just an extra cost. It can be an investment in workers.

Rebuttals Short-Term Consumption Does Not Guarantee Long-Term Growth

The claim that giving excess profits to workers increases spending and productivity is limited. Extra bonuses may increase short–term spending, but this does not always lead to long–term economic growth. Companies also need a lot of money for facilities, research and development, new technology, and future jobs. If excess profits are distributed to workers first, companies may have less money to prepare for future competition. Therefore, giving excess profits to workers may help consumption in the short term, but it can weaken long–term investment and growth.

In terms of Economic

2 Opposition argues that:

Less Investment and Growth

Companies' excess profits should not go to workers before shareholders because this can reduce investment and weaken long-term economic growth. If shareholders receive less reward, companies may become less attractive to investors. Investors may move their money to other companies or markets where they can earn higher returns. Also, once workers receive large bonuses, it may be hard to reduce them later, even when the economy gets worse. Then, companies may have less money for facilities, research and development, new technology, and future jobs.

Rebuttals Worker Rewards Are Also an Investment in Growth

The claim that giving excess profits to workers weakens long-term growth is limited. A company's growth does not depend only on shareholders, facilities, or technology. It also depends on skilled, motivated, and loyal workers. If workers feel that their contribution is recognized, they may work harder, stay longer, and care more about company performance. This can increase productivity and reduce turnover. Therefore, distributing excess profits to workers can also support long-term growth by strengthening workers.

Motion **THBT companies should become public companies when they want to grow.**

Purpose To help students understand the advantages and disadvantages of public and private companies.

Background

When a company wants to grow, it needs more money. It may need money to build factories, hire workers, make new products, or sell things in other countries.

One way to get this money is to become a **public company**. When a company goes public, many people can buy small parts of the company. These small parts are called shares. In this way, the company can get a lot of money from many **investors**.

However, going public is not the only way. A company can also get money from private investors or banks. Also, going public changes how a company makes decisions. A public company must show important information to people. It is checked by investors and the market. This can make the company more open and careful, but it can also make the company worry too much about quick results.

So, we can think about this motion in two ways. First, is going public the best way to get money for growth? Second, does going public help a company make better decisions?

Perspective 1 : Investment

Pro (Going Public Helps Companies Get More Money)

[Assertion] Going public is a powerful way for a company to get a lot of money.

[Reasoning] Growth costs a lot of money. A company may need money to build more factories, make new technology, and hire smart workers. If a company goes public, many people can invest in it. This means the company can get a large amount of money.

Also, money from selling shares is different from a bank **loan**. A bank loan must be paid back. The company also has to pay interest. But money from selling shares does not have to be paid back in the same way. So, going public can give a company more stable money.

[Evidence] Amazon is a good example. Amazon went public in 1997. After that, it

got money from public investors. With this money, Amazon could build warehouses, improve technology, and start new businesses. It grew from a small online bookstore into a huge global company.

Con (Companies Can Grow Without Going Public)

[Assertion] A strong company can grow without becoming a public company.

[Reasoning] Going public is not the only way to get money. A company can get money from private investors or banks. If it borrows money from a bank, the **founder** does not have to give away shares. This means the founder can keep more control of the company.

Also, going public costs a lot of money and brings many rules. A public company must show a lot of information to the public. Its stock price can also go up and down. This can make the company **unstable**.

If a company has very strong technology, private investors may still want to invest in it. So, the company can grow without an **IPO**.

[Evidence] SpaceX is a good example. For many years, SpaceX was a **private company**. It still got money from private investors and grew very fast. It worked on rockets, satellites, and space technology. SpaceX later became public, but much of its big growth happened while it was still private.

Perspective 2 : Decision-making

Pro (Going Public Makes Companies More Careful)

[Assertion] Going public can make a company's decisions more open and **professional**.

[Reasoning] A public company must show important information about its money and business. Because of this, people can check whether the company is doing well.

Also, a public company is not usually controlled by only one person. A group of people checks big decisions. This can stop one founder from making careless choices alone.

In this way, going public can help a company make more careful and responsible decisions.

[Evidence] Meta is a good example. Meta went public in 2012. After that, it had to follow public company rules. It had to show important information and make decisions more carefully. Under this system, Meta continued to grow. It bought WhatsApp in 2014 and invested in new areas such as AI and technology.

Con (Private Companies Can Make Faster and Bolder Decisions)

[Assertion] Private companies can make faster decisions and try bigger ideas.

[Reasoning] A public company is checked by the stock market every three months. Because of this, managers may worry too much about quick results and stock prices. They may not want to take big risks.

However, a private company does not have the same **pressure**. It can think more about the future. It can spend money on difficult projects, even if those projects may fail at first.

So, a private company can move faster and make bold long-term choices.

[Evidence] SpaceX shows this point well. SpaceX had many rocket test failures. If it had been a public company from the beginning, investors might have been very worried. The stock price might have fallen.

However, because SpaceX was private, it could keep trying. It invested in **reusable** rockets, Starlink, and space exploration. These projects were risky, but they helped SpaceX grow. This shows that private companies can sometimes make bold decisions more easily.

Figure out the Clash Points VS ↔

In terms of Investment

1 Proposition argues that:

Going Public Gives Companies More Money

When companies want to grow, they need a lot of money. They may need money to build factories, hire workers, make new products, and sell things in other countries. Going public is a powerful way to get this money because many people can buy shares and invest in the company.

Also, money from selling shares is different from a bank loan. A bank loan must be paid back with interest, but money from selling shares does not have to be paid back in the same way. Therefore, going public can give companies strong and stable money for growth.

Rebuttals Money from Shares Is Not Free

Going public can bring a lot of money, but it is not always the best way to grow. A company must give shares to many investors, so the founder may lose some control. Also, going public costs a lot, brings many rules, and makes the company worry about stock prices. Therefore, public money is useful, but it is not always the safest way to grow.

In terms of Investment

1 Opposition argues that:

Companies Can Grow Without Going Public

Companies do not always need to go public when they want to grow. They can get money from private investors or banks. If a company borrows money from a bank, the founder does not have to give away shares and can keep more control.

Also, if a company has strong technology, private investors may still want to invest in it. So, the company can grow without an IPO. Therefore, staying private can sometimes be a better way for a company to grow.

Rebuttals Private Money May Not Be Enough

Some strong companies can grow without going public, but this is not easy for every company. Private investors do not invest in all companies, and bank loans must be paid back with interest. If a company wants to grow very big, it may need money from many more investors. Therefore, private money can help, but it may not be enough for large growth.

Figure out the Clash Points VS ↔

In terms of Decision-making

2 Proposition argues that:

Going Public Makes Companies More Careful

Going public can make a company's decisions more open and careful. A public company must show important information about its money and business. Because of this, investors and the market can check whether the company is doing well.

Also, a public company is not usually controlled by only one person. A group of people checks big decisions. This can stop one founder from making careless choices alone. Therefore, going public can help a company make more responsible decisions.

Rebuttals Too Much Pressure Can Hurt Good Decisions

Being open and checked by others can be helpful, but it does not always make decisions better. A public company may worry too much about quick results and stock prices. Because of this, managers may avoid risky but important projects. Therefore, going public can make decisions more open, but it can also make companies less bold.

In terms of Decision-making

2 Opposition argues that:

Private Companies Can Make Faster and Bolder Decisions

Private companies can make faster decisions and try bigger ideas. A public company is checked by the stock market every three months, so managers may worry too much about quick results. However, a private company does not have the same pressure.

A private company can think more about the future. It can spend money on difficult projects, even if they may fail at first. Therefore, staying private can help companies make bold long-term choices.

Rebuttals Too Much Freedom Can Be Dangerous

Private companies may have more freedom, but freedom does not always mean better decisions. If there are not enough checks, one founder or a small group of leaders may make risky decisions alone. A public company must follow rules and show important information. Therefore, public companies can sometimes make more balanced and responsible decisions.

Motion **THBT treating everyone the same cannot achieve true equality**

Purpose To analyze the difference between equality and equity and evaluate how each affects fairness in society.

Background

As societies become more diverse, people are thinking more about what true fairness means. Two important ideas are equality and equity.

Equality means giving everyone the same rules, opportunities, or resources. Supporters say this is fair because everyone is treated by the same standard, and no one is officially favored or excluded.

Equity means giving different support based on each person's needs and situation. Since people may start from different social, economic, or physical conditions, giving everyone the same thing may not create equal opportunities. In this view, fairness is not about sameness, but about ensuring **comparable** chances to succeed.

Therefore, this debate asks whether fairness is better achieved through equality or equity, and whether treating people the same or differently leads to a more just society overall.

Perspective 1 : Structural

Pro (Treating everyone the same can preserve existing inequality)

[Assertion] Treating everyone the same can keep existing inequality because people with more money and better education already have many advantages.

[Reasoning] Equal rules do not remove these advantages. In university admissions, wealthy students may receive expensive private education, consulting, and more information. Students from smaller cities may have fewer chances to access the same level of preparation or guidance. As a result, even if the rules are identical, outcomes can still reflect **background** differences, and the same system can make old social and economic gaps continue across generations.

[Evidence] Research on Seoul National University found that students in Seoul had

an admission rate about 2.6 times higher than students outside Seoul, even when academic **potential** was considered. About 92 percent of this gap was linked to parents' economic resources and private education. This shows that equal standards do not always create equal opportunities, and that structural advantages can strongly influence results.

Con (It is difficult to establish clear criteria)

[Assertion] Equity can create new unfairness because it is difficult to decide who truly needs more support.

[Reasoning] A person's disadvantage may depend on income, property, debt, health, family situation, educational background, and many other factors that are hard to measure fairly. However, public systems must use simple legal rules to function efficiently. Because of this limitation, some people who genuinely need help may be left out, while others may receive support because they fit the official category, even if their real situation is not as **severe**. This can lead to confusion and disagreement about what is "fair."

[Evidence] Korea's Basic **Pension** Act generally excludes people who receive certain **occupational** pensions, such as government employee, military, or private school pensions, and their spouses. However, some retired public officials still have very low incomes due to personal circumstances or high living costs. Even so, they may not receive the basic pension because of their category. This shows that equity can create welfare blind spots and unintended exclusion.

Perspective 2 : Individual

Pro (Equity protects dignity and freedom of choice)

[Assertion] Equity is needed to protect individual dignity and real freedom of choice because people have different needs.

[Reasoning] Giving everyone the same resources does not mean everyone can participate equally in real life. A person with a disability, for example, may face physical, technological, or social **barriers** that others do not experience. Without extra support, that person may have the same legal right but not the same real opportunity to succeed

or participate fully. Equity helps reduce these barriers so that individuals can act more independently and with dignity.

[Evidence] Visually impaired students taking Korea's College Scholastic Ability Test answer the same questions as other students, but they receive extra support. Students with severe visual **impairments** get 1.7 times more test time and may use voice-support computers or Braille devices. This shows that different support can be necessary to create equal opportunity in practice, not just in theory.

Con (Equity can cause reverse discrimination)

[Assertion] Equity can cause reverse discrimination because some people may lose opportunities simply because they are not part of a preferred group.

[Reasoning] People should ideally be judged by their ability, effort, and achievement, not only by group identity or background. However, equity policies may give different advantages based on race, gender, disability, or social background in order to correct historical inequality. While this intention is to improve fairness, it can also create situations where individuals feel they are treated unequally despite their **qualifications**, leading to tension and debate about fairness in selection processes.

[Evidence] In the United States, some universities used race as one factor in admissions to increase opportunities for Black and Hispanic students. Critics argued that this could unfairly disadvantage other applicants with strong academic records. In 2023, the U.S. Supreme Court ruled against the race-conscious admissions programs used by Harvard and the University of North Carolina. This shows that equity can create **controversy** and claims of unfairness when group-based considerations affect limited opportunities.

Figure out the Clash Points VS ↔

In terms of Structural

1 Proposition argues that:

Reinforcement of Existing Inequality

Treating everyone the same can keep existing inequality because people do not start with the same advantages.

Wealthy students may have better access to private education, consulting, and useful information, while students from smaller cities may have fewer opportunities.

As a result, equal rules can still lead to unequal outcomes and allow existing social gaps to continue.

Rebuttals Limits of Group-Based Preference

The claim that equal treatment always keeps existing inequality is limited.

Social gaps do not always mean that whole groups should receive special advantages.

People in the same group can have very different situations, while some disadvantaged people outside the group may receive no help.

Therefore, support should focus on each person's actual needs and circumstances.

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In terms of Structural

1 Opposition argues that:

Difficulty in Establishing Clear Criteria

Equity can create new unfairness because it is difficult to decide who truly needs more support.

People's situations depend on many factors, but public systems must use simple legal rules and categories.

As a result, some people who really need help may be left out, creating welfare blind spots.

Rebuttals Improvement of Standards

The claim that equity should be rejected because clear rules are difficult to make is limited.

No welfare system can understand every person's situation perfectly.

However, giving everyone the same support may waste resources and fail to help people with greater needs.

Therefore, the better solution is to improve the rules, not to give up equity.

Figure out the Clash Points VS ↔

In terms of Individual

2 Proposition argues that:

Protection of Individual Dignity and Freedom of Choice

Equity protects individual dignity and freedom of choice because people have different needs.

Giving everyone the same resources may not allow everyone to participate equally in education, work, or society.

Extra support can remove barriers and give each person a fair chance to make choices and succeed.

Rebuttals Equal Rights, Not Different Treatment

The claim that different treatment is necessary to protect dignity and freedom of choice is limited.

Human dignity can also be protected by giving everyone the same basic rights.

If the government keeps treating some people as disadvantaged, it may create stigma and make them depend more on support.

True freedom means making choices and taking responsibility under equal and fair rules.

In terms of Individual

2 Opposition argues that:

Reverse Discrimination Against Individuals

Equity can cause reverse discrimination because some people may receive advantages based on group identity rather than individual ability or effort.

A person may lose an opportunity simply because they do not belong to a group that receives special support.

This can make individuals feel unfairly treated even when they have worked hard or achieved strong results.

Rebuttals Equity Is Not Reverse Discrimination

The claim that equity always causes reverse discrimination is limited.

People do not start from the same conditions because some already have more money, education, information, and social advantages.

Extra support may simply help disadvantaged people take part more fairly.

Therefore, well-designed equity policies can reduce unfair gaps without ignoring individual ability and effort.